EASY GUIDE TO APPLYING TO US COLLEGES & UNIVERSITIES

REQUIREMENTS

- Testing requirements
- Transcripts and Academic records
- Essays and extra-curricular activities
- Recommendations
- Interviews
- Financial Aid Application

1.1 TESTING REQUIREMENTS

Each applicant to both schools (international applicant would need to have the following Standardized test with recommended scores

- ACT – It is scored out of 36, and to apply it is recommended that an applicant has over a score of 30 and above. For more information see the links on the last page
- SAT Reasoning Test – scored out of 800 in 2 sections, summing up to 1600 as a perfect score. Preferably a score of 1400 and above.

1.2 TESTING REQUIREMENTS

- SAT Subject Tests – they are subject based on different subject areas from Physics, Chemistry, Mathematics, Biology to World History. Also scored out of 800. Preferably a score of 750+ in each subject test (Highly recommended), but don't hesitate to apply with any score 700+
- TOEFL – Test of English as a foreign language – It is given on different forms, but it is advised to apply with a score of 100 and higher out 120 (you can convert from different types of the test to compare your score

2. ACADEMIC RECORDS

- School transcript for the last four years of High school
- They need to be certified by the school

Remember;

- These are to uploaded by a college counselor. You will have to submit them to him/her for them to be uploaded.
- A college counselor is an overseer or the key person in charge of your communications between your colleges(the ones you are applying to and your current school).
- In many cases it is an official, but in some cases a teacher in school (preferably the Academic Master) may assume the role

3.1 ESSAYS

- **Essays**
  - are a "KEY & VERY FUNDAMENTAL PART OF YOUR APPLICATION"
  - There are often prompts, which in any case will try to ask you to share about "YOURSELF"
  - Visit the commonapp.org for the essay prompts!
  - There is quite a number of online resources to get help with college essay writing. A good link and example is "The College essay Guy"

3.2 EXTRACURRICULAR

- Activities that a student does to supplement his or her academics in the process of being a "well rounded student".
- Advisably, the range and mix of activities can be;
  - Services – Any thing related to giving (leadership, mentoring, charity, volunteering and many others)
  - Creativity – Centered on self growth. Includes singing, debating, researches that are not in the school's syllabus system, artworks (drawings, paintings), Programming.

3.3 EXTRACURRICULAR

- Action/Sports – Physical endurance activities. Includes soccer, basketball, track and field, tennis, volleyball and many others
- Initiatives – Starting up something on your own (a daring attempt as such would set a difference to standout as an applicant). It may be a club at school, a business, a tuition center, a website or blog , a non profit or for profit organization. It can be on any range (as small as a school, as large as a town or country network
- Jobs – If you have ever had a job whose experience has been significant to your life.

4. RECOMMENDATIONS

- These are letters which other people write about you. You may communicate with them what to share beforehand, but you can not have access to what they wrote about after they submit it
- You would require a minimum of 3 recommendation letters. At least 2 from your subject teachers and 1 from your college counselor
- It is advised to be a mix from different subject areas such as one letter from a Math/Science Teacher, and another letter from a Language/Humanities teacher!

5. INTERVIEWS

- They are arranged by the admission offices
- They are often arranged after you submit your application. If you can meet the interviewer in person, it is highly recommended, but in most cases for international applicants it is done over Skype or in any form of online video or audio chat.
- The key to interviews is enjoying the conversations and being honest. Answer the questions in detail and be confident. Don't be overwhelmed, don't over or under prepare. BE YOURSELF once again
- Always be on time and neat in appearance.

6. FINANCIAL AID

- Applying for financial Aid for international students is often done via the CSS (College Scholarship Service) profile on the college board website.
- Every financial Aid applicant will require to submit a copy of tax forms of two years before. For example if you are applying for financial Aid for the year 2020/21, you need to have your parents full annual tax forms for the year 2018. Sometimes these can be a letter from a parents employer indicating the Parents Annual incomes and taxes or Parent's annual bank statement.
- Often top colleges offer enough aid to support your learning and whilst being fair to the applicant's family. You may need to visit college specific websites and communicate with their offices of admissions on their Financial Aid policies and how much aid you can expect depending on your financial profile

USEFUL LINKS TO THE COLLEGE APPLICATION PROCESS

- For testing:
  - ✓ ACT – https://www.act.org/content/act/en.html#
  - ✓ SATs – https://www.collegeboard.org/
  - ✓ TOEFL – https://www.ets.org/toefl
- For testing practice and exam samples (in addition to the web links given)
  - ✓ https://www.khanacademy.org/sat - SAT
  - ✓ http://www.cracksat.net/index.html - SAT
  - ✓ http://www.crackact.com/ - ACT
- Essay and activity writing
  - ✓ https://www.collegeessayguy.com/
  - ✓ https://www.princetonreview.com/academic-tutoring/subjects/essay-writing
- Financial Aid
  - ✓ https://cssprofile.collegeboard.org/

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